

What to listen for and why?

NPTEL

*MOOC
Soft skills
development*

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Overview

- Quiz
- Introduction
- Relevance of listening
- Barriers to listening
- How to become a good listener
- Listening in groups
- References

Are you a good listener?

- Survey : **How good are your listening skills?**
(Mindtools)

<https://www.mindtools.com/pages/article/listening-quiz.htm>

Please enter your self-assessment scores in the **Discussion Forum** Link provided so that we can know what is the general level of communication skills of this class.

Introduction

Being listened to is so close to being loved that most people don't know the difference.

David Augsberger

- Listening is the mother of all speaking
- The Lament

Relevance of listening in communication

- How We Spend Our Communication Time

- Writing: 9%
- Reading: 16%
- Talking: 30%
- Listening: 45%

– *Worth, 2004 in Palmer, 2014*

According to research, most people believe that they are good listeners. However, findings suggest that the actual efficiency is at only about 25% of our capabilities.

Psychalive, “Are you a good listener”

Hearing and listening are not the same

What did you hear?

Foregrounding

What do you hear?

- Clichés
- Facts
- Thoughts and beliefs
- Feelings and emotions



Information
Emotions

Barriers to listening

- Linguistic
- Physical
- Psychological

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How to become a good listener?

- Preparation
 - Talk less, listen more
 - Don't interrupt... unless needed
 - Develop patience

- Preparatory listening
 - Listen for disrespect
 - Listen for mutual purpose
 - Cultivate 'beginner's ear
 - Manage emotions
 - Empty yourself of bias
 - Practice taking crap

- Listening
 - Listen for emotions – for underlying needs
 - Listen in order to share (thus comfort)
 - Listen to others as you would want them to listen to you
 - Check, feedback
 - Listen for content, in order to connect
 - Tell me more – genuine curiosity
 - Defensive – non-defensive
 - Listen for differences – towards empathy

- Deep listening
 - Listen between words
 - Listen for inconsistencies
 - Listen to classify, categorize information
 - Listen for convergences and divergences

Listening in groups

- Listen for content, intent and attitude
- Compare and categorize speakers
- Assimilate information
- Classify them
- Get ready to speak

Summary of key points

- Listening is very important in communication
- Most of can improve our listening skills
- Empathy, sensitivity, alertness and patience can significantly improve our listening skills
- Listening is the first step in the direction of speaking
- Listening in group interactions can be socially and professionally very helpful

References

- “Are you a good listener.” *Psychalive*.
<http://www.psychalive.org/quiz-are-you-a-good-listener/>
- Palmer, Erik (2014). *Teaching the core skills of listening and speaking*. UK. ASCD, 2014.
- Brady, M and Austin, J. A (2005). *little book of listening skills*. Paideia Press.